

A state of affairs is contingent just in case (i) it actually is the case, and (ii) it is not necessary (that is, it is possible that it not be the case).

Here are some examples of contingent facts.

Once you understand what possible and necessary mean, you can understand what it takes for a state of affairs or thing to be **contingent**.

possible

necessary

contingent

Notre Dame is in Indiana.

You are a student at Notre
Dame.

Most of the earth is covered
in water.



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



objections
to the
PSR

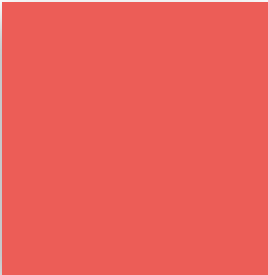
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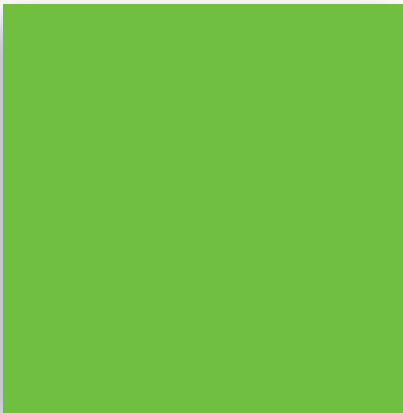
(ii) it is not necessary (that is, it is possible that it not be the case).

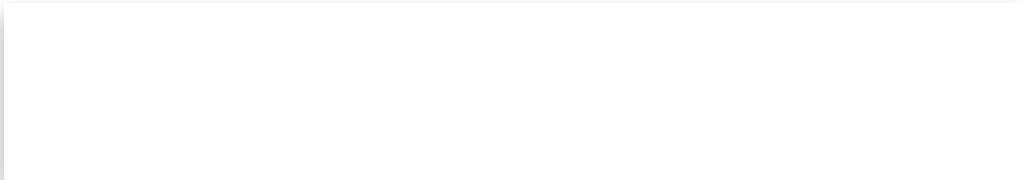
understand what it takes for a thing to be contingent.

Once you understand what possible and necessary mean, you can

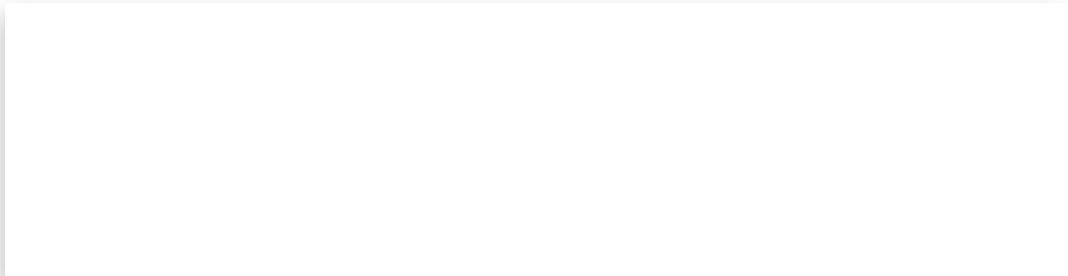






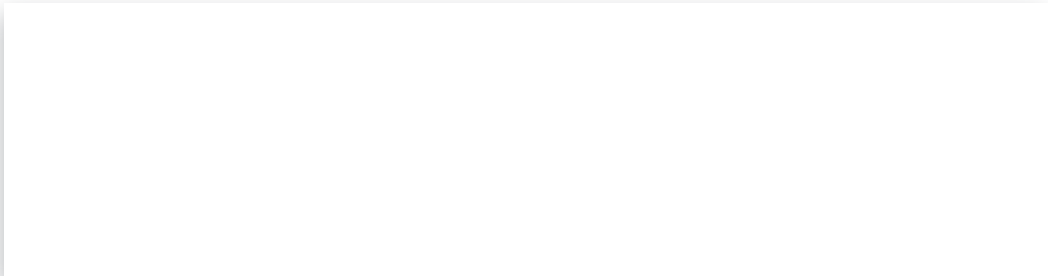


Notre Dame is in India.



You are a student at Notre

Dear.



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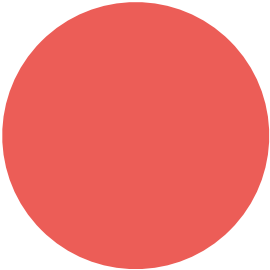
Most of them are covered

... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

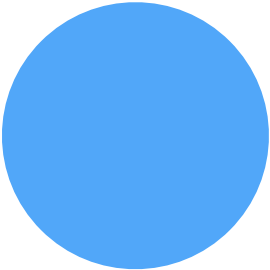
What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.







objections
to the
PSR





simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to

Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first

cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could

be Good.



Leibniz's
argument

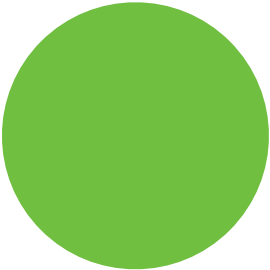


the
PSR





Leibniz's
argument



possible

necessary

contingent